

CHEYENNE ALISE BLACK

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Norman, OK 73069

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, The University of Oklahoma Expected May 2026

Concentrations: Public Policy, Research Methodology, American Government

Dissertation: *Rethinking Space Policy: From Outer Space to Inner Dynamics Using Discourse Network Analysis, Topic Modeling, and Policy Actor Affiliations* (In progress)

Chair: Joseph Ripberger, Committee: Deven Carlson, Charles Finocchiaro, Mark Raymond, Shad Satterthwaite

M.A., Political Science, University of Oklahoma May. 2022

Concentrations: Public Policy and Research Methodology

Thesis: *Astro-nots Bezos, Branson, and Musk compared to NASA and the ESA: Using Twitter to Assess Public Sentiment Differences between Commercial and Government Space Programs*

B.S., Political Science, Appalachian State University

Concentration: Legal Studies May 2019

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Space Policy, Science and Technology Policy, Environmental Policy

Secondary: Public-Private Partnerships, Policy Process, Policy Analysis, Research Methods

CERTIFICATIONS AND SUPPLEMENTAL EDUCATION

Department of Commerce Sensitive Data Stewardship Certification, ICPSR Maximum Likelihood Estimation: Generalized Models, ICPSR Mathematics for Social Scientists II, ICPSR Regression Analysis II: Linear Models, IQMR Computational Text Analysis, IQMR Network Analysis, IQMR Bayesian Statistics, IQMR Comparative Historical Analysis, RAND Forecasting Initiative (RFI) Training

PROGRAMMING/SOFTWARE SKILLS

R, STATA, ArcGIS, Python, Qualtrics, LiMA, L^AT_EX, NVivo, Discourse Network Analyzer (DNA), APIs, Machine Learning, Microsoft 365 Products, Google Products

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Summer Associate May 2025 – Current

The RAND Corporation

Supervisor(s): Eder Sousa; Bonnie Triezenberg

- Work on a research project evaluating the evolution of USAF fighter jet capability and applying this in a framework for USSF to modernize legacy space systems. Completed in RAND's Defense & Political Sciences (DPS) Department in Santa Monica, CA.

Graduate Research Assistant Jun. 2022 – May 2025

The Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis

Supervisor(s): Joseph Ripberger; Hank Jenkins-Smith

- Assist in research projects on policy topics including, but not limited to, national security, the environment, artificial lights at night, weather risk communication, and nuclear arsenal retention.
- Provide support in creating frequency reports, preparing presentation materials, collaborating on research projects, and authoring academic materials.

VSFS Graduate Student Assistant

Sep. 2023 – Sep. 2024

U.S. Department of State - Office of Policy, Planning, and Resources, VSFS

Supervisor: Thomas Wonder

- Assist in gathering information and analyzing global public opinion topics and information through the Research and Evaluation Unit (REU).
- Work on projects concerning climate change and green transition in Europe, attitudes and behaviors of disinformation, security cooperation, and views on trade and foreign investment.

VSFS Graduate Student Assistant

Aug. 2020 – Jun. 2023

U.S. Department of State - Greening Diplomacy Initiative, VSFS

Supervisor: Stephanie Christel

- Assist in coordinating air quality program operations through the Greening Diplomacy Initiative between the Department of State, EPA, NASA, and US Forest Service.
- Organize air quality data, embassy, post, and consulate POC information, and MOUs.
- Create reports to assist in the correction of air quality monitors to efficiently collect data, publish blog posts, and assist in discrete projects.

Census Field Supervisor

Jan. 2020 – Jul. 2020

U.S. Census Bureau, Level: GS 04; Clearance: Confidential

Supervisor: Starr Wright

- Train and supervise Enumerators and Census Field Supervisor Assistants to complete operations.
- Evaluate performance and recommend changes to data collection methods to Field Manager and office staff.
- Create assignments in the Operational Control System.
- Review and certify Enumerator's time and expense records.
- Resolve personnel conduct and performance problems.
- Safeguard personally identifiable information and business identifiable information.
- Report data for the Western North Carolina region.

Address Analyst and Canvasser

Aug. 2019 – Jan. 2020

U.S. Census Bureau, Level: GS 03

Supervisor: Audrey Duncan

- Use a satellite interface system (LiMA) to update and register housing in the US Census database.
- Communicate with members of the public on the upcoming Census and the importance of its completion.
- Update data systems to demonstrate living quarters that were built, destroyed, altered, or moved.
- Uphold data stewardship of personally identifiable information and business identifiable information.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Aug. 2024 – Current

University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science

- Develop and deliver university-level courses: *Making Public Policy (PSC 3223)* and *Introduction to Political Data (PSC 2013)*.
- Design and prepare course materials, including syllabi, lecture slides, and assignments.
- Provide instruction to 30 students in PSC 3223 and 20 students in PSC 2013.
- Evaluate and grade coursework, ensuring timely feedback to students.
- Conduct office hours to support student learning and address questions.
- Manage all administrative aspects of courses, including communication with students and maintaining records.

Graduate Assistant

Jan. 2024 – Current

University of Oklahoma, Price College of Business

Supervisor(s): Shad Satterthwait; Jeremy Leader; Jason Kessler

- Assist with management of *The Future of Space* and *Space and Small Business* courses in the Price College of Business Commercial Aerospace Applications certificate program.
- Manage grades, Canvas pages, syllabus structure, and assist with technical aspects of course.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2020 – May 2022

University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science

Supervisor(s): Kathleen Tipler

Melody Rowlett

- Teach, manage, and curate lesson plans for lab sections of *Intro to American Politics and Democracy*.

PUBLICATIONS

Black, Cheyenne. (2025). “Astro-nots Bezos, Branson, and Musk compared to NASA: promises and pitfalls of using sentiment analysis to assess differences between commercial and government space missions.” *Quality and Quantity*: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11135-025-02213-8>

Peach, Kaitlin, Andrew Fox, Kuhika Gupta, Joseph Ripberger, Cheyenne Black, Tristan Winkle, and Hank Jenkins-Smith. (2025). “American Public Opinion on US Responses to Russia’s Nuclear Threats in Ukraine.” *Global Policy*: doi.org/10.1111/1758-5899.13490

Jimenez, Miguel F, Ali Khalighifar, Carolyn S Burt, Cheyenne A Black, Maggie Len-Corwin, Andrew S Fox, Hank C Jenkins-Smith, et al. (2025). “Integrating Multi-Scale Terrestrial and Atmospheric Predictors Enhances Nocturnal Bird Migration Forecasts.” *Ornithological Applications*: doi.org/10.1093/ornithapp/duaf001

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Let there be light? Partisanship differences in light pollution mitigation strategies – Black et al.

Public attitudes and perspectives on the tradeoffs associated with limiting nighttime lighting – Fox, A. S., et al.

WORKING PAPERS

Nuclear Arsenal Policy Beliefs Overtime: An assessment of Cultural Theory and ideology measurement consistency - Black et al.

Light Pollution as Everyday Life: objective and perceived measures of artificial lights at night – Corwin et al.

The Color of Risk: A systematic review of color in risk communication - Ripberger et al.

The Nascent Light Pollution Policy Subsystem: Issue attention cycle dynamics and subsystem typology - Black and Jenkins-Smith

TECHNICAL REPORTS

Department of State – *Addis Ababa Air Quality Monitor Installation* – DipNote

Department of State – *NASA & the MAIA Project* - DipNote

Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis - *Public Preferences for U.S. Response Options to Potential Russian Use of Nuclear Weapons in Ukraine* - White Paper

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Analytical Article *The Conversation*

May 2024

”US participation in space has benefits at home and abroad: reaping them all will require collaboration”

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

”From Apollo to Artemis: Transformations in the U.S. Space Policy Subsystem and Coalition Dynamics” *International Conference on Public Policy*. July 2025.

”Nuclear Arsenal Policy Beliefs Overtime: An Assessment of Cultural Theory and Ideology Measurement Consistency” *Conference on Policy Process Research*. May 2024.

"Navigating the Cosmos of Coalition Changes: An Exploration of Shifting Discourse Networks in Space Policy" *Midwestern Political Science Association Annual Conference*. April 2024.

"Let there be light? Partisanship Differences in Light Pollution Mitigation Strategies." *Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference*. January 2024.

"The Changing Face of Space Policy: Discourse Networks, Affiliations, and Coalition Dynamics." *Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference*. January 2024.

"Assessing Partisanship Presence in the Light Pollution Policy Subsystem." *Advocacy Coalition Student Group*. September 2023.

"Using Twitter to Assess Public Sentiments of Government and Commercial Space Programs." *Oklahoma Aerospace and Defense Innovation Institute*. October 2022.

"Assessing Public Sentiments Using Twitter Data." *Dialogues of Contemporary Sociology*. December 2020.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer 2024 - Current

Review of Policy Research, European Policy Analysis, Quality and Quantity

Panel Chair and Discussant July 2025

International Conference on Public Policy

Visiting Researcher Lecture October 2024

"Introduction to Machine Learning and Policy Research."

Institute of Comparative Politics and Public Policy (CoPPP)

Round Table Participant October 2024

"Public Policy in the Polycrisis."

German Political Science Association Conference

Panel Chair and Discussant June 2024

Virtual Southern Political Science Association Conference

Panel Chair May 2024

Conference on Policy Process Research

Guest Lecture February 2024

"Introduction to Space Policy." OU Political Science 3223, Making Public Policy

Reoccurring Guest Lecture November 2021 - 2024

"U.S. Environmental Policy Overview." OU Political Science American Federal Government Seminar

LEADERSHIP

Ask a Mountaineer program Sept. 2020 – Current

Appalachian State University - Alumni Network,

Mentorship Program Affiliate Sept. 2020 – Current

Alpha Gamma Delta Int. - Upsilon Chapter, University of Oklahoma

Vice President Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2023

Graduate Association in Political Science, University of Oklahoma

Senator Oct. 2020 – Oct. 2021

Graduate Student Senate, University of Oklahoma

President Mar. 2018 – Apr. 2019

Phi Alpha Delta Law Fraternity, Int., Appalachian State University

Public Relations Chair Mar. 2017 – Apr. 2018

Phi Alpha Delta Law Fraternity, Int., Appalachian State University

Senior Class Senator Apr. 2018 – May 2019

Student Government Association, Appalachian State University

Board Member	Feb. 2017 – May 2019
Organizational Conduct Board, Appalachian State University	
Director of Leadership	Dec. 2017 – May 2019
Alpha Gamma Delta Int. - Nu Alpha Chapter, Appalachian State University	

HONORS AND AWARDS

Frances E. and A. Earl Ziegler Sooner Heritage Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma (\$2000)	2025
John Halvor Leek Memorial Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$1400)	2025
Robert E. and Mary B. Sturgis Endowed Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma (\$1800)	2025
Sarkeys Foundation Sooner Heritage Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma (\$2000)	2025
David R. Morgan Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$600)	2024
IQMR Funding Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$3280)	2024
Robberson and Wethington Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma, Graduate College (\$850)	2024
Frances E. and A. Earl Ziegler Sooner Heritage Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma (\$2000)	2024
John Halvor Leek Memorial Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$245)	2023
Sooner Heritage Scholarship , The University of Oklahoma (\$1,000)	2023
Best ADQUANT Research Title , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Sociology	2021
H.V Thornton Memorial Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$1,8000)	2021
Research Funding Award , The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science (\$1,000)	2021
Certificate of Appreciation , U.S. Department of State	2021
Sister of the Year , Alpha Gamma Delta Nu Alpha Chapter	2018
Burgettstown Area Scholarship Series , Burgettstown Area Scholarship Fund (\$1,000)	2014

PAST AND PRESENT AFFILIATIONS

American Political Science Association
 Association for Public Policy and Management
 European Consortium for Political Research
 German Political Science Association
 Midwestern Political Science Association
 Southern Political Science Association
 Women Also Know Stuff